

TATA'S AIR INDIA: BRAND REPOSITIONING AND REVITALIZATION CHALLENGES¹

Nitin Gupta wrote this case solely to provide material for class discussion. The author does not intend to illustrate either effective or ineffective handling of a managerial situation. The author may have disguised certain names and other identifying information to protect confidentiality.

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“We have set out to create an airline that ranks among the best in the world and will proudly represent the new India on the global stage. And we have made quite a remarkable progress in a very short space of time.”

Campbell Wilson, chief executive officer of Air India²

Campbell Wilson made his observations about the accomplishments of Air India on January 27, 2023, a year after the Indian government formally handed over control of the state-run airline to Tata Sons Pvt. Ltd. (Tata), the winner of a bidding process for the airline. After nearly seven decades, the airline was returning to the conglomerate that had founded it in 1932.³ While some industry experts felt that Tata's takeover of Air India was the best chance the airline had for a commercial revival,⁴ others were not so optimistic. Air India had returned to Tata with a severely dented reputation, including being known for negative passenger experiences due to bad service, frequent delays, and flight cancellations. At this stage, it would be a daunting task for Tata to rejuvenate Air India.⁵

Wilson was confident for an effective turnaround for Air India despite lingering scepticism. His ambitious objectives included capturing 30 per cent of India's domestic aviation market in the next five years by doubling Air India's fleet size and building multiple hubs across cities to increase share in international traffic.⁶ Wilson wanted to brand Tata-owned Air India as the “*carrier of choice for passengers worldwide*” competing with top airlines like Emirates and Singapore Airlines.⁷ Could Wilson succeed in his seemingly implausible objective? What strategies should Wilson adopt to lead Air India through a drastic brand repositioning? Could he succeed in revitalizing the company's brand and making it a sought-after airline brand worldwide?

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Air India was founded by the Tata Group in October 1932 as Tata Airlines by JRD Tata, the illustrious Indian business pioneer. On October 15, 1932, Tata Airlines operated its first flight, ferrying mail between Karachi and Mumbai. After India achieved its independence in August 1947, Air India International was formed to fly overseas, with the government of India holding a 49 per cent stake in the firm. The airline's first international flight was from Mumbai to London on June 8, 1948. It was on a 40-seater Lockheed Constellation aircraft named as the Malabar Princess. Over the years, the airline enhanced its reputation for

superior in-flight and on-ground services. It was during that time that the company's famous Maharaja mascot was created. In 1953, the government of India nationalized the airline. Over the years, the official apathy and mismanagement took a toll on the national airlines, and by the end of the financial year (FY) 2021, it ended up with total losses of ₹839.16⁸ billion.⁹

Air India's increasing losses forced the Indian government to divest from the airline, despite multiple failed attempts. Finally, in October 2021, the government wrote off part of the airline's debts and managed to sell Air India and its low-cost subsidiary Air India Express to Talace, the Tata subsidiary, for ₹180 billion. The control of the airlines was transferred from the government to Tata on January 27, 2022.¹⁰ After the acquisition, Tata owned two full-service airlines (Air India and Vistara) plus two low-cost carriers (Air India Express and AirAsia India). Vistara was in a tie-up with Singapore Airlines, whereas AirAsia India was operational with the Malaysian-based airline group AirAsia.¹¹

ENTER WILSON

Air India was known for its poor customer service, dated manual systems, and old and inefficient aircraft. To initiate this airline's turnaround, Tata had planned to invest ₹150 billion on building talent, training, deployment of technology systems, and creating a modern fleet, in addition to improving ground handling through data analytics.¹² Wilson, an aviation veteran from Singapore Airlines, was given the charge of Air India in June 2022 with a mandate to transform the airline and create a customer-centric and service-oriented culture. He was expected to develop a new operational structure and fix the systems and processes to ensure on-ground efficiencies, besides reducing daily losses. Revitalizing the airline would be Wilson's immediate focus.¹³

From finding components for seats that were no longer manufactured to flying aircrafts that had been cannibalized for spare parts, Wilson had embarked on one of the most challenging aviation turnarounds of contemporary times. His future course of action was divided into what he saw as a three-phase process: taxi, take-off, and climb. In phase one (taxi), he planned to tackle everything that tarnished the Air India brand. In phase two (take-off), he would initiate accelerated investment in systems, processes, people, and equipment, including aircraft. In the third phase (climb), which would be initiated after five years, the airline would be catapulted from very good to world-class status. This blueprint included handling various issues that ranged from reducing delays to improving onboard meals, to upgrading the airline's website, with the aim of restoring the trust of passengers to make them flock to Air India.¹⁴

INDIAN AVIATION MARKET

The Indian aviation market was growing at such a tremendous pace that air travel demand exceeded the supply. The Boeing Company (Boeing) expected India to have the world's fastest growth in air traffic by 2040. Experts believed that India's growing economy and rapid urbanization, along with Indian consumers' enhanced aspirations and disposable incomes, would lead to exponential air traffic growth in the coming years. However, Indian Government's major worry was the loss of substantial international air traffic originating from India to Dubai-based Emirates and Doha-based Qatar Airways. To mitigate this market loss, Indian carriers were pushed to cater to this demand by purchasing more aircrafts.¹⁵ Aviation experts were baffled. The country boasted over one billion consumers with rising personal incomes, economic growth, an upward mobile middle class, and a vast Indian diaspora. And yet, Air India was the only primary international carrier from India. The airline was a minor player in the global sector, rather than being one of the largest international carriers in the world.¹⁶ According to data released by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation, domestic airlines in India carried approximately 12.32 billion passengers between January and December 2022, up from 8.38 billion during the same period one year earlier, registering an annual growth of 47 per cent.¹⁷ During that

time, the major domestic players operating in India were InterGlobe Aviation Limited (or IndiGo), Vistara, Air India, AirAsia India, SpiceJet, Go First, and Akasa Air (see Exhibit 1).¹⁸

STRATEGIC INITIATIVES

Wilson and Natarajan Chandrasekaran, the chairman of Tata Group, had ambitious plans for improving Air India. Chandrasekaran had identified four core areas on which Air India would focus: “1) *providing best-in-class customer service*, 2) *making it the most technologically advanced airline in the world*, 3) *upgrading and modernizing the fleet*, and 4) *improving both in-flight and off-flight hospitality*.”¹⁹ Wilson wanted to initiate significant cultural changes in Air India’s fleet, website, operations, revenue, data management, and staff. He believed that despite having many good people, a good brand, pride, national support, geographic opportunity, and a large diaspora, Air India suffered because of a lack of proper management and investment.²⁰

Alliances with Other Tata Companies

Different Tata Group companies were using their core competence to revive Air India (see Exhibit 2). The flight catering arm of Taj Hotels, called TajSATS, was delivering improved onboard meals, whereas crew accommodations were provided by the Indian Hotels Company. Tata Technologies helped design some obsolete aircraft seat components by using three-dimensional (3D) design and manufacturing from scratch to accelerate the repair of seats. A team from Tata Business Excellence, which comprised representatives from most Tata Group companies, provided business analysis to improve company performance. The team was also helping Air India identify opportunities for improvement and efficiency.²¹ Tata was evaluating plans to set up a ground-handling services company to meet Air India’s burgeoning in-house needs. These services added to the consumer experience and were critical to building a formidable global aviation entity. In some domestic airports, ground-handling services for Air India passengers were provided by Air India SATS, a joint venture with Singapore-based SATS Airport Services.²² Tata Group flagship Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) significantly contributed to the technological rebuild of Air India’s backbone. A TCS team was working on integrating the airline’s software with the One Tata Operating Network and boarding it to the Tata Neu mobile application, which was referred to as a “*super app*.”²³ Jaguar Land Rover provided assistance on cabin design and branding opportunities.²⁴

Initiating Human Resources Turnaround

On its acquisition, Air India comprised around 13,000 employees, among which 8,000 were permanent, and the rest were contractual. Air India’s average employee age was 53, with an average retirement age of 58. To overhaul the employee structure, Tata offered a voluntary retirement scheme to existing Air India employees and approximately 4,500 employees opted for it. Additionally, about 4,000 employees were expected to retire by 2025. Air India had launched a major recruitment drive and hired senior talent from Tata Group companies such as TCS and Tata Digital to oversee “*customer experience, ground handling, the airline’s website, call centres, and several other digital initiatives*”. To contest against its competitors internationally, Air India required the resources with the right blend of ability and attitude.²⁵ The airline had added 1,200 professionals to its ground staff and intended to bring over 4,200 cabin crew trainees on board, who would undergo rigorous training on safety and service skills. Additional plans were to hire 900 pilots in 2023.²⁶ To reconstruct its core team, Air India was attempting to hire executives from competitors by offering them higher compensation packages. The Tatas had appointed a slew of external consultants to oversee the turnaround. PricewaterhouseCoopers had been engaged to advise on workforce management and expansion.²⁷ The conglomerate was also banking on talent and expertise from its allied business to turn around the carrier (see Exhibit 3). Control of Air India’s crucial commercial department was given to Nipun

Aggarwal, Tata's senior vice-president. Suresh Dutt Tripathi, who was a former head of human resources at Tata Steel, was appointed chief human resource officer. Rajesh Dogra, a TCS veteran, was promoted to head of customer experience and ground handling. Satya Ramaswamy, who had been head of strategic initiatives at Tata Digital, was made the airline's chief digital and technology officer.²⁸ The airline also hired Sunil Suresh, a former executive at MakeMyTrip, into the position of chief marketing officer. Colin Neubronner, who had earlier worked on branding Singapore Airlines and Jet Airways, was made part of a new brand-building team at Air India.²⁹

Tata was overhauling Air India's human resources processes. Air India opened a direct communication channel for employees to contact management and resolve their issues. It planned to have periodic town hall meetings where employees would have the opportunity to ask questions and engage directly with top management executives. Air India created indirect recognition programs to reward good performance. As an incentive for employees to improve their performance, Air India rolled out a stock sharing plan that offered workers approximately 3 per cent of its equity share capital. Air India appointed SBI Caps Trustee Company Ltd. to implement the stock sharing plan.³⁰

New Technological Initiatives

To modernize its digital landscape and improve its customer engagement and operational efficiencies, Air India made an initial investment of US\$200 million and was expected to sustain this pace of investment over the next five years. These initiatives would deliver the website, mobile application, in-flight-entertainment modernization, and a user-friendly customer notifications system.³¹ Air India was also planning to use GPT4, the latest and enhanced version of the viral chatbot ChatGPT, to improve customer experience on its website. The initial plan was to use this technology to enhance the Frequently Asked Questions section on the website, enabling it to answer questions related to varied topics from baggage allowance and the best fares to the most feasible flight times. The entire graphic user interface would eventually be powered by GPT4.³²

A new customer relationship management contract for Air India was given to the US-based cloud software company Salesforce Inc., which would manage the company's relationships and interactions with existing and potential customers. The contract for enterprise resource planning was given to the German multinational software company SAP SE, which would integrate multiple functions at Air India such as planning, purchasing inventory, sales, marketing, finance, and human resources. For the first time in Air India's history, every penny it earned and spent would be digitized and easily accessible.³³

Tata Technologies was working on modernizing Air India's operations by digitizing its fleet and equipment data, as well as introducing digital solutions for aircraft maintenance. Alope Palsikar, the executive vice-president and head of growth industries and Nordics - a subsidiary - at Tata Technologies, announced that the digitization of the overall system had started. The upgrades included digitizing data management, cabin engineering, fleet and equipment data, aircraft maintenance, repair, and the overhaul unit that the Tatas had acquired along with the airline.³⁴

In August 2022, Tata installed the online business communication platform Workplace, from Meta Platforms Inc., to keep Air India's vast workforce connected. This was the first time the airline had digitized office communication for its staff. It would enable better and more active engagement between a diverse group of employees including pilots, cabin crew, engineers, commercial specialists, information technologists, ground handling specialists, and many others across the globe. According to Ramaswamy, the airline was reimagining its employee experience to attract, retain, and encourage top-level talent.³⁵

Combining Airlines

Tata and Singapore Airlines planned to combine Air India and Vistara, of which Tata owned 51 per cent and Singapore Airlines owned the remaining 49 per cent. This move would create India's largest international and second-largest domestic carriers in market share and aircraft fleet (see Exhibit 4). As part of the deal, Tata would hold 74.9 per cent in the combined entity, while Singapore Airlines would own 25.1 per cent. Singapore Airlines would invest ₹20.59 billion in the combined entity as part of the transaction. Subject to regulatory approvals, this merger was expected to conclude by March 2024. Until then, both Air India and Vistara would continue to function independently, but the brand Vistara would be phased out after the merger. Vistara had a fleet of 54 aircraft, which was to expand to 70 by December 2023. The integration was expected to provide Air India a domestic market share of 26 per cent, making it a powerful rival to the market leader IndiGo, which had a market share of 57 per cent and a fleet of 289 aircraft.³⁶ Tata also merged AirAsia India and Air India Express to create a low-cost airline with a new brand identity.³⁷ In November 2022, Tata bought the 16 per cent stake of its Malaysian partner in this airline³⁸ and received regulatory approval for the merger.³⁹ Tata maintained that it would retain the airline's Maharaja mascot for its brands.⁴⁰

Aircraft Refurbishment, Lease, and Alliance Plans

Air India's narrow-body fleet stood at 70 aircrafts, of which 54 were in service, and its wide-body fleet stood at 43 aircrafts, of which 33 were operational. The remaining aircraft were undergoing repairs.⁴¹ Tata was grappling with Air India's old broken planes tainting its brand identity and creating negative customer perception. This made Air India initiate an extensive refurbishing of its existing aircraft with new seats, cushions, and entertainment screens.⁴² A plan worth \$400 million for the refurbishment of the entire wide-body and narrow-body fleet was publicized.⁴³ However, worldwide supply chain problems delayed it.⁴⁴ The entry of the first refurbished aircraft was anticipated by mid-2024. Passengers complained of broken seats, problems with in-flight entertainment, and faulty lavatories on Air India flights. To solve these issues, the airline aligned with JPA Design and Trendworks, London-based product design companies, which would help refurbish its cabin interiors.⁴⁵

To address the problem of aircraft shortage and accelerate Air India's expansion pace, Tata announced its plan for a short-term lease of 36 aircrafts to join its fleet by 2023, enabling it to increase its flights to European and North American cities. With 19 long-grounded aircrafts also returning to service, Air India enhanced flight frequency between key Indian cities and major international destinations in the Middle East, Europe, and the US. Russia's Ukraine invasion on February 24, 2022,⁴⁶ led many US and European airlines to avoid Russian airspace, which added transit time to India and made many flights unviable. To counter the situation, Air India increased its flights to Europe and the United States. The airline increased the frequency of flights to the United Kingdom from 34 per week to 48. Flights from India to the United States were also increased, from 34 to 40 per week.⁴⁷ Air India deployed a disproportionate amount of capacity into the international long-haul market, which was historically a more profitable market than the domestic sector. In the domestic sector, Air India's push was more toward the corporate routes that covered important cities for business, including Delhi, Mumbai, and Bangalore. The company believed that such routes were more aligned with its full-service proposition and brand. The aircraft was leased, which provided better business-class and premium economy seats. Air India expected that the upgrades would make its customers willing to pay higher prices and the airline would become more attractive to high-yielding traffic.⁴⁸

The expansion in the international sector would also be through a mix of direct flights and partnerships with other airlines for codeshare and interline agreements.⁴⁹ Lufthansa, the giant German carrier, planned to deepen its co-operation with Air India in several areas, including the expansion of codeshare and the provision of engineering and aviation training to Air India staff. Carsten Spohr, the chief executive officer and board chair of

Lufthansa Group believed that Air India was well positioned to become a hub airline for traffic between Southeast Asia, the Southwest Pacific, and Europe.⁵⁰ To increase its global footprint through codeshare agreements, Air India was also in talks with members of Star Alliance, a 26-member international airline group whose members shared aircraft, passengers, and airport amenities through flight codes, cross-ticketing, and sharing of airport lounges. It would enable Air India to offer its flyers a seamless overseas travel experience.⁵¹

Historic Purchase Deal

In February 2023, Tata confirmed its plan to purchase 470 planes from Airbus SE (Airbus) and Boeing to enable Air India's massive future expansion. The airline would receive 250 planes from Airbus and 220 from Boeing at an estimated cost of about \$100 billion at list prices (before applicable discounts), making it one of the biggest purchases in modern aviation history. The Airbus order included 210 narrow-body planes (A320 Neos and A321 Neos) and 40 wide-body planes (A350-1000 and A350-900). The Boeing order consisted of 190 units of the 737 Max aircraft, 20 units of the 787-9 model, and ten units of the 777 model, with an option to buy an additional 50 units of the 737 Max planes and 20 units of the 787 model.⁵² This order also included the option of purchasing 370 more aircraft from Airbus and Boeing over the next decade. With such a large fleet, Air India could connect India non-stop to every major city in the world, putting forth a challenge to foreign airlines who had for decades flown people between India and the rest of the world through their hubs abroad.⁵³ The creditworthiness of Tata would allow the airline to raise funds at lower rates of capital for financing the aircraft purchase. Air India was slated to receive 25 Boeing 737 Max and 6 Airbus A350-900 aircraft by the first half of 2024. Tata's financial track record also enabled it to win Power-by-Hour agreements with engine makers GE Aerospace and Rolls-Royce Holdings. This practice bound the engine manufacturer to offer replacement and maintenance as needed.⁵⁴

IMPROVEMENTS

With numerous strategies being implemented for its improvement in the previous year, when it came under the realm of Tata, Air India was showing some positive results. Air India boosted its finances with better cost management and yield improvement on international routes, which, after many years, led it to generate positive earnings for FY2023. Its average revenue per mile had improved to around 6.5 from 4.5 in FY 2020, making it log its highest-ever passenger revenue of ₹31 billion in December 2022. Revenue performance for the airline had improved significantly. Under Tata's ownership, Air India was earning ₹1 billion per day compared to ₹70 million per day earlier. The airline improved its yield significantly by employing performance-linked incentives for travel agents and new revenue management software that enhanced its business class load factor. However, due to expenses incurred on the grounded aircraft's return into service and refurbishment of the plane's interiors, the airline's cost per available seat mile had remained high.⁵⁵

Under Tata's ownership, Air India had shown better performance than the domestic market leader IndiGo on one of its major branding parameters—on-time performance. Between July and September 2022, Air India consistently beat IndiGo in this punctuality pecking order. This was made possible through the efforts of a cross-functional team with employees from various departments. The team comprehensively assessed the upcoming flight schedule and applied technology to improve the capability of predictive aircraft maintenance and turnaround time.⁵⁶

ISSUES

Experts generally approved of many of Tata's initiatives, including re-engineering Air India's various processes, re-equipping it with the required resources, refurbishing the aging grounded aircraft, and adding new crew members. However, enforcing the "softer" aspects of caring for customers and maintaining consistency in service excellence was a more challenging task, especially in an airline that had become moribund, indifferent, and insensitive to customers over the decades that it operated as a public sector undertaking.⁵⁷ Under Tata's ownership, Air India was still trying to address the massive glitches in customer support and product experience it faced daily.⁵⁸ Problems with old aircraft and technology malfunctions had continued to surface periodically, preventing the carrier from soaring to its full potential.⁵⁹

Air India was overstaffed and needed to be rightsized. However, according to the acquisition agreement that Tata had signed with the Indian government in January 2022, it could not change Air India employees' "Terms of Employment" until March 2023. A new service agreement to be implemented on January 1, 2023, had to be postponed due to opposition from Air India's employee unions, which were unusually strong due to Air India's public sector legacy. The unions challenged the new employee policies and wrote a letter to the Government of India Chief Labour Commissioner highlighting the illegality of service condition changes due to the continuing industrial dispute. While Air India wanted to recognize and reward customer-centric behaviours to encourage accountability among its employees, the unions were resisting these initiatives toward greater responsibility.⁶⁰ Unions representing Air India pilots were against the hiring plan for new captains, which they perceived would adversely impact the career advancement of existing first officers. According to the unions, the proposed plan would generate artificial distinction between old and new pilots. Tension seemed to be rising between pilots and the new Air India management.⁶¹ Experts were also concerned about Tata's proposed integration of Vistara and AirAsia India's brands into the Air India fold. The former two airlines were less than a decade old, and their cohort was much younger than that of Air India. Integrating these two varied groups was one of the challenges that Air India would have to face.⁶²

To provide some services to its customers, Air India still depended on various government entities, such as the government-owned Air India Air Transport Services Limited (AIASL) that was responsible for ground services at various domestic airports. Due to deteriorating ground service standards that delayed many of the carrier's flights every month, Air India threatened to end its contract with the government entity. Air India complained that the ground handling service was perennially short of workforce, had inadequate training, mishandled baggage, and used ground service equipment that was dysfunctional due to ineffective maintenance, in addition to some staff members exhibiting improper behaviour toward customers.

Air India communicated its complaints in a formal letter that included specific criticism of AIASL:

*As you would appreciate that, for any airline to be able to deliver enhanced customer experience, ground-handling operations such as check-in, boarding, baggage handling, and ramp side activities are extremely critical. While we are working towards exponentially improving our customer experience, AIASL is unable to match the requisite pace of change, and we continue to face several challenges at the airports managed by AIASL as ground-handling services provider for Air India.*⁶³

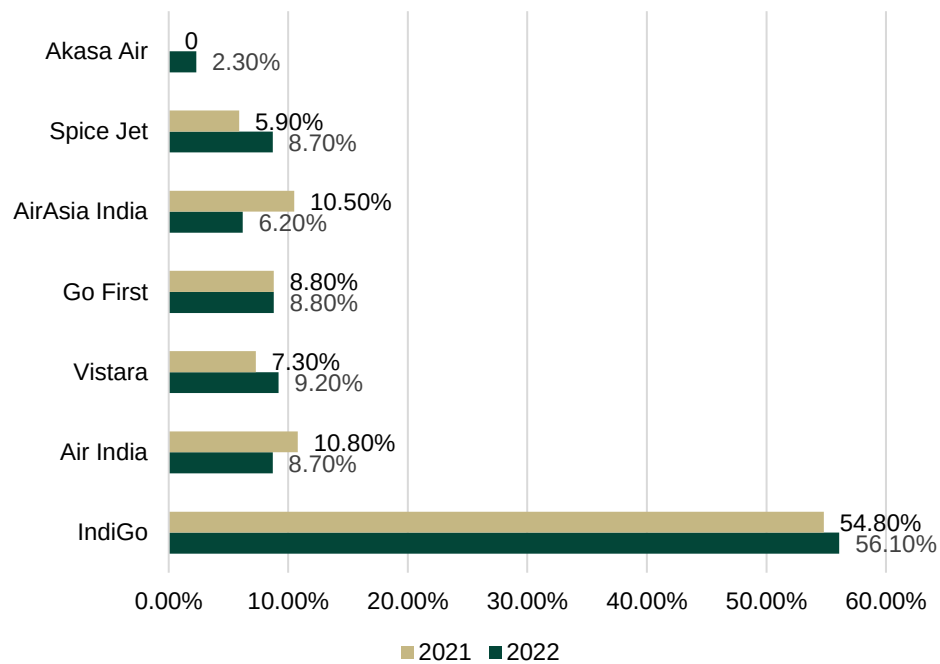
In November 2022, there was a serious controversy over how Air India handled an incident, where "an allegedly drunk business-class passenger was accused of urinating on an older woman on an Air India flight". A penalty of ₹3 million was levied on Air India in addition to the suspension of the flight's captain by the Indian aviation regulator, who maintained that the airline had not followed the given rules in handling and reporting the incident. Post that incident, Air India issued a new alcohol policy and an updated system for crew members to report unruly passengers.⁶⁴

THE WAY FORWARD

Despite the myriad issues that Air India was still facing after having been under Tata's ownership for one year, Tim Clark, the chief executive officer of Emirates, believed that *"the best thing that could have happened to Air India was for Tatas to take it over."* According to Philip Goh, the regional vice-president for Asia Pacific at the International Air Transport Association, *"If correct strategies are used, Air India can become a very powerful player in the Indian market . . . Air India can definitely be strengthened. If there's one group that can do it, it's the Tatas."*⁶⁵

Wilson concurred with the opinions of these experts. He observed that the airline had already improved its on-time performance and other aspects, indicating that it was moving on the right track. Wilson believed that Air India could *"take people from Southeast Asia to the Middle East or from the Indian subcontinent to North America using Indian airports as hubs in the same way that some of our neighbours do."*⁶⁶ For this to happen, however, he knew that he had to successfully reposition and revitalize the airline's brand image and make it a sought-after airline across the world.

Futurebrands, a London-based brand and design consultant firm that had worked on various prestigious projects like the rebranding of American Airlines, Bentley, and the 2012 London Olympics, was hired by Tata to reformulate Air India's branding strategy. It was asked to refurbish Air India as an international airline of choice.⁶⁷ But Wilson still faced challenges. To improve Air India's brand image, what would be the right path to follow? What strategies would be successful in revitalizing the brand and making Air India a leading global airline?

EXHIBIT 1: MARKET SHARE OF DOMESTIC AIRLINES IN INDIA, 2021 AND 2022

Note: Akasa Air figures for 2021 are not available since the airline was established in August 2022.

Source: Swaraj Baggonkar, "Air India's Market Share Sinks to Lowest Ever in 2022," *Financial Express*, January 20, 2023, <https://www.financialexpress.com/industry/air-indias-market-share-sinks-to-lowest-ever-in-2022/2954249>.

EXHIBIT 2: COMPANIES CONTRIBUTING TO AIR INDIA'S REVIVAL**Tata Group Entities**

Company	Proposed Contribution to Air India's Revival
Talace	Tata subsidiary that bought Air India from the Indian Government
TajSATS	Delivering improved onboard meals to Air India
Indian Hotels Company	Crew accommodation for Air India
Tata Technologies	Design seats for Air India aircraft and modernize its operations by digitizing
Tata Business Excellence	Help Air India identify opportunities for improvement and efficiency
Air India SATS	Provide ground-handling services for Air India passengers in some airports
Tata Consultancy Services	Integrate Air India software with One Tata Operating Network
Jaguar Land Rover	Help with cabin design and branding opportunities
Tata Digital	Manage digital initiatives of Air India

Non-Tata Group Companies

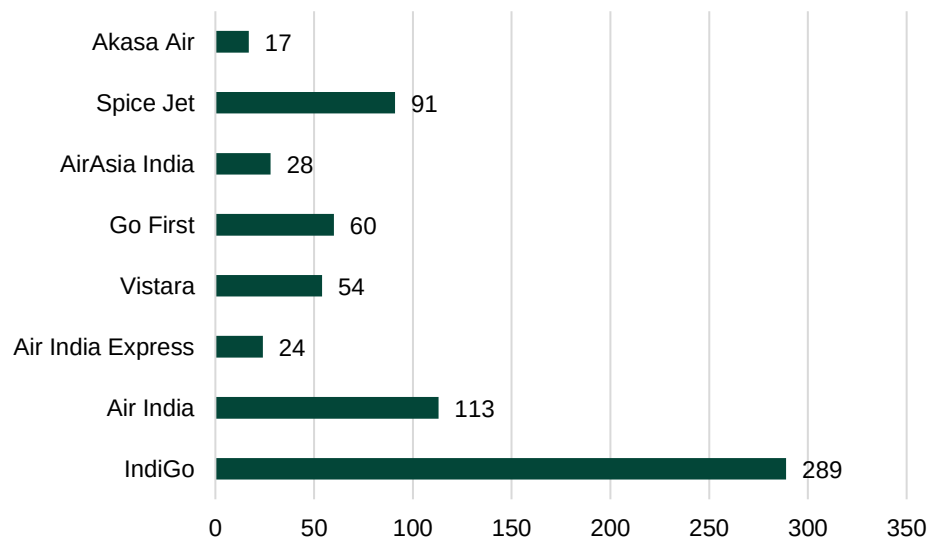
Futurebrands	Refurbish Air India identity to become an airline of choice worldwide
PricewaterhouseCoopers	Advise on Air India's workforce management and expansion
SBI Caps Trustee Company Ltd.	Help Air India implement employee share benefit scheme
Salesforce Inc.	Manage Air India customer relationship management program
SAP SE	Provide Air India enterprise resource planning system
Meta Platforms Inc.	Connect Air India's vast workforce
Singapore Airlines	Hold a 25.1 per cent stake in Air India
JPA Design and Trendworks	Assist in the refurbishment of Air India cabin interiors
Lufthansa	Provide codeshare services, engineering, and aviation training
Star Alliance	Enable Air India to offer passengers seamless overseas travel experience
Airbus SE	Manufacture 250 planes for Air India
The Boeing Company	Manufacture 220 planes for Air India
GE Aerospace and Rolls-Royce Holdings	Replace and maintain aircraft engines

Source: Compiled by the author from: Anirban Chowdhury and Sangita Mehta, "Tata Eyes ₹15k cr Working Capital Debt for Air India," *The Economic Times*, October 29, 2022, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/india/tata-eyes-15000-crore-working-capital-debt-for-air-india/articleshow/95154334.cms>; Saurabh Sinha, "All Hands on Deck: How Tata Companies Help Revamp Air India," *The Times of India*, October 19, 2022, <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/business/india-business/all-hands-on-deck-how-tata-companies-help-revamp-air-india/articleshow/94974867.cms>; Kala Vijayaraghavan and Anirban Chowdhury, "Tata Plans to Set Up Ground-handling Business Under Air India," *The Economic Times*, April 11, 2023, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/tata-plans-to-set-up-ground-handling-business-under-air-india/articleshow/99385474.cms>; PTI, "Air India's Progress Has Been 'Nothing Short of Stunning': CEO Campbell Wilson," *The Economic Times*, January 27, 2023, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/air-india-progress-has-been-nothing-short-of-stunning-ceo-campbell-wilson/articleshow/97363554.cms>; Kala Vijayaraghavan and Anirban Chowdhury, "Air India Is Like a Startup as It's Being Reinvented, says CEO Campbell Wilson," *The Economic Times*, March 13, 2023, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/air-india-is-like-a-startup-as-its-being-reinvented-says-ceo-campbell-wilson/articleshow/98588257.cms?from=mdr>; Arindam Majumder, "Air India to Get a Brand Makeover, London Based Consultancy Firm Roped In," *The Economic Times*, December 2, 2022, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/air-india-to-get-a-brand-makeover/articleshow/95921330.cms>; Arindam Majumder, "Air India Rolls Out a Staff Stock Option Plan," *The Economic Times*, January 26, 2023, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/air-india-offers-nearly-98-crore-shares-to-employees-under-stock-option-scheme/articleshow/97323271.cms>; ET Bureau, "Air India Gets Workplace from Meta to Digitise Office Working," *The Economic Times*, August 16, 2022, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/air-india-gets-workplace-from-meta-to-digitise-office-working/articleshow/93585220.cms?from=mdr>; Arindam Majumder, "Air India to Refurbish Its Aircraft to Give It a Premium Avatar," *The Economic Times*, December 9, 2022, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/air-india-draws-up-400m-plan-to-renovate-its-fleet/articleshow/96093276.cms?from=mdr>; Saurabh Sinha, "Lufthansa Plans to Deepen Ties with Air India," *The Times of India*, December 20, 2022, <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/business/india-business/lufthansa-plans-to-deepen-ties-with-air-india/articleshow/96356840.cms>; Anirban Chowdhury, "As Star Alliance Member, Air India Can Raise the Bar: Jeffrey Goh," *The Economic Times*, June 28, 2022, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/as-star-alliance-member-air-india-can-raise-the-bar-jeffrey-goh/articleshow/92500470.cms>; Arindam Majumder, "Air India to Buy 250 Planes from Airbus, 220 from Boeing," *The Economic Times*, February 15, 2023, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/air-india-to-buy-250-planes-from-airbus-220-from-boeing/articleshow/97927587.cms>; Arindam Majumder, "Tata's Profile and M&A Experts Help Air India to Win a Cost Effective Deal," *The Economic Times*, February 16, 2023, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/aided-by-tata-credit-profile-air-india-may-find-it-cheaper-to-buy-widebody-jets/articleshow/97959722.cms?from=mdr>.

EXHIBIT 3: KEY PEOPLE BEHIND AIR INDIA'S REVIVAL

Name	Designation
Campbell Wilson	Chief Executive Officer, Air India
Natarajan Chandrasekaran	Chairman, Tata Group
Nipun Aggarwal	Senior Vice-President, Tata Sons
Suresh Dutt Tripathi	Chief Human Resource Officer, Air India
Rajesh Dogra	Head, Customer Experience and Ground Handling, Air India
Satya Ramaswamy	Chief Digital and Technology Officer, Air India
Sunil Suresh	Chief Marketing Officer
Colin Neubronner	Head, Brand Building Team, Air India
Aloke Palsikar	Executive Vice-President and Head of Growth Industries and Nordics, Tata Technologies

Source: Compiled by the author from PTI, "Air India's Progress Has Been 'Nothing Short of Stunning': CEO Campbell Wilson," *The Economic Times*, January 27, 2023, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/air-indias-progress-has-been-nothing-short-of-stunning-ceo-campbell-wilson/articleshow/97363554.cms>; Arindam Majumder, "Air India to Get a Brand Makeover, London Based Consultancy Firm Roped In," *The Economic Times*, December 2, 2022, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/air-india-to-get-a-brand-makeover/articleshow/95921330.cms>; Anirban Chowdhury, "Tata Technologies Is Set to Begin Work Soon on Modernising Air India Operations: Aloke Palsikar," *The Economic Times*, August 4, 2022, <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/transportation/airlines/-aviation/tata-technologies-is-set-to-begin-work-soon-on-modernising-air-india-operations-aloke-palsikar/articleshow/93332278.cms>.

EXHIBIT 4: NUMBER OF AIRCRAFT WITH MAJOR AIRLINES IN INDIA

Source: Reeba Zachariah, "Tata's Boarding Call: Vistara to Be Merged into Air India," *The Times of India*, November 30, 2022, <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/mumbai/tatas-boarding-call-vistara-to-be-merged-into-air-india/articleshow/95870278.cms>; Reuters, "After Air India, Now Akasa Air May Place Large Plane Order in 2023," *Live Mint*, February 16, 2023, <https://www.livemint.com/news/akasa-air-to-place-large-plane-order-in-2023-eyes-international-growth-11676539637051.html>.

ENDNOTES

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